eCAMPUS UNIVERSITÀ | DiSTA

Lingua inglese

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PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

We use the **Present Perfect Simple** to talk about events:

- which happened not long ago (but we don't tell when) and have results now

I **have lost** my keys.

Someone **has eaten** all the cakes!

Fred can't walk because he **has broken** his leg.

- which happened in the past, but we don't know or we are not interested in when they happened. We also use it when something has not happened yet but is possible to happen in the future.

Ann **has been** to Italy twice.

I **haven't been** to Japan yet.

Steve is very successful: he **has written** two novels and many theatre plays.

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

Time expressions often used with the Present Perfect Simple:

already, ***ever***, ***never***, ***just, yet, still, lately, recently.***

Just used with the present perfect means ‘a short time before’.

*I’ve **just** met your sister.*
*Tom’s **just** called. He can’t come to the party with us.*

Yet used with the present perfect means ‘at any time up to now’. We use it to emphasise that we expect something to happen soon. ***Yet*** (in this context) is only used in **negative sentences** and **questions**.

*Have you booked the holiday **yet**?*
*I haven’t been to Barcelona **yet**.*

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

Still used with the present perfect means that something hasn't happened. We use it to emphasise that we expected the thing to happen earlier. ***Still*** (in this context) is only used in **negative sentences**.

*I've been waiting for an hour and the bus **still** hasn't come.*
*They **still** haven't finished that project.*

Already used with the present perfect means 'before now'. We use it to emphasise that something happened before something else or earlier than expected.

*I've **already** spent my salary and it's two weeks before payday.*
*They have left **already**!*

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

Formation rule: **have/has** + past participle

In the case of **regular verbs** add **-*d*** or-***ed*** to the infinitive; if the verb is **irregular**, use its 3rd form.

Paul **has repaired** your watch.

Paul **hasn't repaired** your watch.

Has Paul **repaired** your watch?

You **have done** your homework.

You **haven't done** your homework.

Have you **done** your homework?

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

We use the **Present Perfect Continuous** to talk about activities:

- which started in the past and continue up to now

I **have been** study**ing** English since 2005.

We **have been** liv**ing** here for more than 10 years.

George **has been** read**ing** that book for 3 months.

- from the recent past which have results in the present

Sheila's clothes are dirty. She **has been** paint**ing** her room.

Patrick is very tired. He **has been** work**ing** hard.

Your clothes are wet. **Have** you **been** wash**ing** the car?

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Expressions often used with the Present Perfect Continuous: ***for, since***.

We use **for** + a period of time

We use **since** + the start of a period

FOR
two hours
a long time
50 years
20 minutes
five days
six months
a week
ages
years

SINCE
8 o'clock
Monday
10 April
June
2022
Christmas
lunchtime
we arrived
I got up

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Formation rule: **have/has been + V-ing**

They **have been** liv**ing** here ***since 1990***.

They **haven't been** liv**ing** here for a long time.

How long **have** they **been** liv**ing** here?

Pamela **has been** wait**ing** for you ***for an hour***.

Pamela **hasn't been** wait**ing** for you for an hour.

Has Pamela **been** wait**ing** for you for an hour?

Pres. Perf. Simple vs. Pres. Perf. Continuous

PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE	PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS
Focuses on the result	**Focuses on the activity**
You've washed your hair! It looks beautiful!	*I've been gardening. The weather is lovely.*
Says 'how many'	**Says 'how long'**
She's written twenty emails this morning.	*She's been writing emails all day.*
Describes a completed action	**Describes an activity which may continue**
I've finished this book.	*I've been reading this book for a month.*
	When we can see evidence of recent activity
	Your clothes are dirty. Have you been painting?

Present Perfect vs. Past Simple

The Present Perfect is a ***present*** tense. It always tells us about a situation *now*. e.g. Rick **has broken** his arm. (It means that he cannot play tennis *now*)

The Past Simple tells us only about the ***past***. e.g. Rick **broke** his arm last summer. (It means that he has recovered in the meantime, and *now* he can play tennis.)

<u>Compare</u>:

George **has lost** his key. = He cannot get into his house. NOW – effect on present

George **lost** his key last week. = Last week he could not get into his house. IN THE PAST – happened in the past, does not effect the present (He has either found it in the meantime, or has a new one.)

Present Perfect vs. Past Simple

We can use the Present Perfect for new or recent happenings.

I'**ve repaired** the washing machine. It's working now.

We use the Past Simple for things that are not recent or new.

Mozart **was** a composer. He **wrote** more than 600 pieces of music. (he died, he cannot write more pieces of music)

<u>Compare</u>:

Somebody **has invented** a new smartphone.

Alexander Graham Bell **invented** the telephone.

Present Perfect vs. Past Simple

Do NOT use the Present Perfect when you talk about a finished time.

e.g. **yesterday / ten minutes ago / in 2022 / when I was a child / last year, month, week**

It **was** very cold yesterday.

Did you **play** a lot when you were a child?

Use the past to ask **When** … ? or **What time** … ?

What time did you **finish** work?

Present Perfect vs. Past Simple

PRESENT PERFECT	PAST SIMPLE
We use the Present Perfect for a period of time that continues until *now.* E.g. **today / this week / since**	We use the Past Simple for a *finished* time in the past. E.g. **yesterday / last week / from 2010 to 2012**
It **hasn't rained** this week.	It **didn't rain** last week.
Have you **seen** Paul recently?	**Did** you **see** Tim on Sunday?
Have you **seen** Lisa this morning? (it is still morning)	**Did** you **see** Lisa this morning? (it is now afternoon or evening)
We'**ve been waiting** for an hour. (we are still waiting)	We **waited** for an hour. (we are no longer waiting)
Chris lives in New York. He **has lived** there for twenty years.	Gene **lived** in York for five years. Now he lives in Manchester.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

PRESENT PERFECT

Task 1

Complete each sentence with the Present Perfect Simple form of the verb in brackets. Do not use contracted forms.

1) I _____ (see) many beautiful places in my life.

2) Judy _____ (not write) the email yet.

3) Mobile phones _____ (change) our lives.

4) _____ you _____ (hear) anything about her?

5) She _____ already _____ (do) her homework.

6) The kids _____ (break) the window.

7) I _____ never _____ (eat) Japanese food.

8) Peter _____ just _____ (finish) cooking.

9) _____ you ever _____ (drink) Irish coffee?

10) My neighbour _____ (win) on the lottery.

Task 2

Complete the sentences with the Present Perfect Continuous form of the verbs in brackets. Do not use contracted forms.

1) I _____ (work) on this project for three months.

2) How long _____ you _____ (live) in Rome?

3) They _____ (not speak) to each-other for months.

4) His back hurts because he _____ (garden) all morning.

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5) What _____ she _____ (do) since our last meeting?

6) We _____ (stand) here for an hour.

7) I am so tired. I _____ (sit) at my desk all day.

8) How long _____ Emily _____ (play) the piano?

9) Louisa _____ (cooking) that turkey since 3 o'clock.

10) They _____ (play) football for 2 hours.

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KEY

Task 1

1) have seen

2) has not written

3) have changed

4) Have … heard

5) has … done

6) have broken

7) have … eaten

8) has … finished

9) Have … drunk

10) has won

Task 2

1) have been working

2) have … been living

3) have not been speaking

4) has been gardening

5) has … been doing

6) have been standing

7) have been sitting

8) has … been playing

9) has been cooking

10) have been playing

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PAST SIMPLE, PAST CONTINUOUS, PRESENT PERFECT SIMPLE

Choose the correct form of the following verbs.

1) John *waited/was waiting* for me when I arrived.

2) I *was reading/have read* this book three times.

3) When *did you finish/were you finishing* cooking?

4) This is the first time I*'ve been/was* on a plane.

5) While my mom was ironing, I *was sleeping/slept*.

6) While I was walking, I *was meeting/met* my best friend.

7) I *didn't go/haven't gone* to work yesterday.

8) Where *have you lived/did you live* ten years ago?

9) They *have won/have been winning* five trophies.

10) Last summer we *went/were going* to Spain.

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KEY

1) was waiting

2) have read

3) did you finish

4) ’ve been

5) was sleeping

6) met

7) didn’t go

8) did you live

9) have won

10) went

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